



### The Exorcist Sequel

Blumhouse is developing a sequel to "The Exorcist", slated to be directed by David Gordon Green. <http://digit.in/jan21-27>



### Sarah Polley's "Women Talking"

The adaptation follows a group of women in an isolated religious colony, struggling with sexual assaults. <http://digit.in/jan21-28>



sight of bleak, dried-up vegetation in its wake. It's a part of nature's cycle, and thus had to be recreated in the show as well. In the third episode, there are scenes shot over at Central Park, where one of the dares in the notebook forces Dash to mimic a living statue for 10 minutes. The background of this scene features a blindingly white sky, and an entire set of dying trees, with barely any leaves clinging onto its branches. But as mentioned earlier, at the time of filming, these trees were completely fine. In order to achieve the barren and gloomy scenery in the most natural way possible, CBFX implemented a quite smart and efficient trick. Which was to film the exact same shot, at two separate intervals in time, and then merge them. As stated by Regentin, originally, the ac-



tors were shot in front of greenscreens, when the trees were green. The crew then came back to the location in winter, to shoot the exact same backdrop. From there on, it was simply a matter of replacing and merging the original green screen background with the newer one.

As for the remaining, autumn coloured vegetation, the team chose to colour-correct much of the foliage to a deep brown or red, while keeping the

shrubby dark green. During this process, it was important to leave a good amount of brightly popping colours in the shots, to seamlessly capture the holiday feel and magic. John Renzulli (CEO / Chief Creative, Chicken Bone FX), further touched upon their creative process by saying, "We love 'weatherizing' to complement the story being told."

### TURNING RAIN TO SNOW

It's a universally accepted law that all good things must eventually come to an end. In Dash & Lily's case, it's all about putting an end to the cheerful Christmas season, and welcoming the



year ahead. The final episode of the season takes you to a New Year's Eve party, where we see the Jonas Brothers playing a live concert, in the middle of a snow flurry. As lively and vibrant as the performance looks, you would have probably guessed by now that the snowfall, is obviously fake. But, there is a twist. This time, filming took place on a rainy day. Meaning, CBFX had to work with that footage and create a winter concert scene, by replacing the raindrops with snowflakes. Based on the weather forecast, the day of the shoot was actually supposed to be sunny. But unfortunately, midway through, it started to rain, which further led to the filming process being halted. In the interest of saving time, Regentin and his team persuaded the production crew to keep filming, given that VFX would help by adding snow or rain to the other (previous) shots, for continuity. "The decision was propelled by a

very quick proof-of-concept we made of a falling snow treatment, composited on a couple of takes from the other day," says Regentin. Fair to say, the filming resumed smoothly, which brings us to the real task at hand.

Coming to post-production, a good majority of the visual effects process merely involved adding tons of snowfall onto the footage, and playing it off of concert lights; to the point, where it would cover-up and overshadow much of the rainfall. Which is why, when you closely compare the snowfall in this particular scene, to any other scenes from within the show, you notice an increase in the density and the amount of snowflakes flowing across your screen. Simply because, there actually is, more falling snow. As for the removal of rain droplets, it was only needed for a few of the shots, such as close-ups. "We found that the real rain would read as snow once we added our VFX layers, and it really transformed the whole scene," says Regentin. "Instead of a dreary, rainy concert, I think we created some real New York Jonas Brothers holiday magic!"

Thanks to Chicken Bone FX, Dash & Lily was able to unfold a wondrous Christmas tale about the two lovers. Taking on this task wasn't that easy of a deal, considering, by the time they actually began working on the project, the pandemic had begun. Adapting to the new normal put a lot of mental



and emotional stress onto the team. But, thanks to their pre-existing virtual workflow system, and the timely and efficient mental health support, CBFX was able to push through, and masterfully churn out a cosy holiday special, just in time!

Watch "Dash & Lily" on Netflix. [d](#)